Lusha Xu

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics, University of California, Riverside

Department of Economics · Riverside, CA

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EDUCATION

University of California, Riverside — Riverside, CA
Ph.D. in Economics — *Expected 2027*

University of California, Riverside — Riverside, CA
M.S. in Statistics — *Expected 2027*

California State University, Sacramento — Sacramento, CA
M.S. in Economics — *2020*

Guizhou University — China
B.S. in Electrical and Electronics Engineering — *2010*

RESEARCH AREAS

Macroeconomics · Machine Learning and Text-as-Data · Applied Econometrics · Monetary and Financial Economics

WORKING PAPERS

[1] "From Financial Reports to Macroeconomic Forecasts: An LLM-Based Approach" *Job Market Paper.*

This paper investigates whether corporate financial narratives contain forward-looking macroeconomic information. Using a large language model, I extract 38 quantitative measures from 60,236 SEC Form 10-K and 10-Q filings (1996–2026), aligned by EDGAR filing date. These soft-information indicators predict firm-level outcomes and track macroeconomic benchmarks. Constructing weekly leading and coincident indices via dynamic factor models, I evaluate real-time forecasts for 2013–2019. Bridging the indices reduces the mean squared forecast error of an autoregressive benchmark by 17% for current-quarter GDP growth and 18% one quarter ahead, averaged over weeks 5–13. The filing-based measures also improve GDP quantile forecasts, industrial production point forecasts, and year-ahead inflation quantile forecasts. These findings show that corporate disclosures provide useful signals of aggregate activity and macroeconomic risk.

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

[1] "Central Bank Digital Currency and Bank Intermediation with Risky Loans."

Develops a micro-founded general equilibrium model to study how interest-bearing central bank digital currency affects bank intermediation when banks make risky loans. The model examines how CBDC remuneration interacts with deposit competition, bank funding costs, lending decisions, and default risk.

[2] "Corporate Narratives and Forecast Errors Around Recessions"

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor — *University of California, Riverside*

ECON 003: Introduction to Microeconomics — Summer 2023, Summer 2025
ECON 104B: Intermediate Microeconomic Theory II — Summer 2024

Teaching Assistant *University of California, Riverside*

Ph.D. Core Courses

ECON 201A: Macroeconomic Theory I	Fall 2022
ECON 201B: Macroeconomic Theory II	Winter 2024, 2025

Undergraduate Courses

ECON 002: Introduction to Macroeconomics	Spring 2023, Fall 2024
ECON 003: Introduction to Microeconomics	Summer 2026
ECON 102: Intermediate Microeconomics	Fall 2021
ECON 103: Intermediate Macroeconomics	Winter 2022/2023, Summer 2022, Spring 2024
ECON 105A: Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory I	Fall 2023
ECON 109: Forecasting in Business and Economics	Spring 2025
ECON 135: The Stock Market	Spring 2022, Fall 2026

Conference and Seminar Presentations

2027	2027 AEA Annual Meeting, Lightning Round, Washington, DC, USA (*scheduled*)
2026	SEA 96th Annual Meeting, Houston, TX, USA (*scheduled*)
	CES China Annual Conference (*online*)
	46th International Symposium on Forecasting, Montréal, Canada
	UC Riverside Macroeconomics Seminar
2025	35th Annual Midwest Econometrics Group Conference, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, IL, USA
2023	UC Riverside Macroeconomics Reading Group
2022	UC Irvine Macro Brownbag Seminar
	UC Riverside ECON-GSA Brown Bag Seminar

Honors & Awards

Dissertation Research Grant	2026–2027
Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, University of California, Riverside	2024–2025
Teaching Assistantship, University of California, Riverside	2021–2026
GSA Conference Travel Grant, University of California, Riverside	2023–2027
Dean's Distinguished Fellowship, University of California, Riverside	2020–2021
International Student Fee Waiver, CSUS International Programs and Global Engagement	2018

Professional Experience

Lead Consultant, *Graduate Quantitative Methods Center*, UC Riverside	2025–2026
Co-Organizer, *UC Riverside ECON-GSA Brown Bag Seminars*	2023–2024
Financial Manager, *Aeron Energy Technologies Co., Ltd.*, China	Aug 2014–Apr 2017
Rebate Specialist, *Shanghai ICSON Co., Ltd.*, China	Feb 2014–Jul 2014
Financial Analyst, *Shanghai Xingxing Finance Consulting Co., Ltd.*, China	Apr 2012–Jun 2013

Referee, *Journal of Business Cycle Research*

Additional Information

Software	Python, R, SQL, Stata, MATLAB, LaTeX
Membership	AEA · AFA · IIF · CES
Languages	Mandarin Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)

References

Marcelle Chauvet (Advisor)
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Joseph Cummins (Placement Director)
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